

# Caleb H. Kelley, Ph.D.

Visiting Assistant Professor  
Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University

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*Last updated: August 2025*

## EDUCATION

### Ph.D. in Romance Languages

*The University of Alabama*

**August 2017 – August 2024**

Tuscaloosa, AL

- **Dissertation:** *Sounding gay and straight in Seville: A variationist perspective on persona and syllable-final /s/ realization*
- **Advisor:** Dr. Erin O'Rourke

### M.A. in Romance Languages

*The University of Alabama*

**August 2015 – May 2017**

Tuscaloosa, AL

### B.A. in Spanish

*University of Alabama at Birmingham*

**August 2010 – December 2013**

Birmingham, AL

### B.S. in Biology

*University of Alabama at Birmingham*

**August 2010 – December 2013**

Birmingham, AL

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research explores the intersection of language, identity, and social meaning, focusing on how speakers use phonetic variation to construct and negotiate social identities in Spanish-speaking communities. Grounded in sociophonetics and third-wave sociolinguistics, I employ performance-based methodologies that foreground social personae to examine how linguistic choices both reflect and shape identity. My work engages with questions of gender, sexuality, and representation, offering insights into language's role in fostering critical awareness, cultural competence, and inclusive leadership. In teaching, I integrate these perspectives with second language acquisition and culturally responsive pedagogy to create learning environments that empower students to be effective communicators in a global context.

**Areas of specialization:** Hispanic linguistics; phonetics and phonology; sociolinguistics; language variation and change; dialectology; quantitative/experimental methodology; language, gender, and sexuality; second language acquisition; marginalized dialects; language attitudes and ideologies; educational technology

# EMPLOYMENT

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| <b>Visiting Assistant Professor</b><br><i>Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University</i>                                     | <b>2024 – present</b><br>Atlanta, GA |
| <b>Graduate Teaching Assistant/Instructor of Record</b><br><i>Department of Modern Languages and Classics, The University of Alabama</i> | <b>2015 – 2024</b><br>Tuscaloosa, AL |
| <b>Adjunct Instructor of Spanish</b><br><i>Department of English and World Languages, University of Montevallo</i>                       | <b>2021 – 2022</b><br>Montevallo, AL |

# PUBLICATIONS

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## Manuscripts in Preparation

**Kelley, C. H.** (in preparation). Prosodic identity performance in Sevillian Spanish: A mixed-effects analysis of gay and straight vocal personae [Revising for submission to the *Journal of Language and Sexuality*]

**Kelley, C. H.** (in preparation). Vowel space and performed identity in male Sevillian speech [Revising for submission to *Spanish in Context*]

## Research Projects in Progress

**Sociophonetic Perception of Sexual Identity: Evidence From Native and Non-Native Spanish Speakers**

- IRB approved Bilingual (Spanish/English) perception experiment using matched guise methodology
- Data collection phase: Fall 2025/Spring 2026

## Planned Research

**Kelley, C. H.** Machine learning applications in regional dialectology: Computational methods for analyzing sexual identity markers across Spanish-speaking regions.

# PRESENTATIONS

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## Guest Lectures

Fall 2020. *Phonetics and Phonology Workshop*. Invited Guest Lecture: SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language course, Tuscaloosa, AL.

## Conference Presentations

**Kelley, C. H.** (2024). Phonetic dimensions of gay-sounding speech in Spanish: Syllable-final /s/ variation and persona performance. Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 2024: University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

**Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Analyzing the phonetic performance of male sexuality in Sevillian Spanish through remote data collection. New Ways of Analyzing Variation (NWAV) 51: Queens College, Flushing, NY.

**Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Analyzing the performance of male sexuality in Spanish through remote data collection and digital corpus analysis. Congreso Internacional de Lingüística Digital (CILiDi) 2: Universidad de Alicante, Alicante, Spain.

**Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Syllable-final /s/ and the sociolinguistic construction of personae in Spanish speakers. OSU Congress on Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics Symposium (OSUCHiLL) 27: The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH. (Virtual).

**Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Using sociolinguistic personae to analyze phonetic variation among gay and non-gay Spanish speakers. University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC): The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

**Kelley, C. H.** (2022). A pilot study investigating sociophonetic variation among LGBTQ+ speakers in Peninsular Spanish. University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC): The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

**Kelley, C. H.** (2021). Sounding queer in Spain: A sociophonetic analysis of production and perception. Lavender Languages & Linguistics 27: California Institute of Integral Studies, San Francisco, CA. (Virtual).

**Kelley, C. H.** (2020). Sounding gay and straight in Granada, Spain: Sociophonetic evidence from production and perception. Lavender Languages & Linguistics 27: California Institute of Integral Studies, San Francisco, CA. (Postponed due to COVID-19).

Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2020). Very? Much!: A corpus analysis of alternation between 'muy' and 'mucho' in Spanish. 10th International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics: Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA. (Canceled due to COVID-19).

Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2017). 'To be' or 'To not be': Attitudes and behaviors toward the split infinitive in English. 8th International Contrastive Linguistics Conference: National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Athens, Greece.

**Kelley, C. H.** (2016). The Madre Maria de San José (1656-1719) Project. Digitorium: University of Alabama Digital Humanities Conference: The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

**Kelley, C. H.** (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 3: University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

## Poster Presentations

**Kelley, C. H.** (2022). Performing sexual orientation in Spanish: A pilot study investigating persona and syllable-final /s/ realization. 10th Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics (WSS10): University of Georgia, Athens, GA. (Virtual).

**Kelley, C. H.** (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. Quantitative Methods in Linguistics course research showcase: The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

## GRANTS, HONORS, & AWARDS

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Research support award</b><br>\$675, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics                               | <b>2024</b>        |
| <b>Conference funding award</b><br>\$500, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics                             | <b>2023</b>        |
| <b>Research support award</b><br>\$450, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics                               | <b>2023</b>        |
| <b>Conference funding award</b><br>\$800, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics                             | <b>2023</b>        |
| <b>Lewis and Clark Fund for Exploration and Field Research (not funded)</b><br>\$5,000, American Philosophical Society | <b>2023</b>        |
| <b>Research support award</b><br>\$600, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics                               | <b>2022</b>        |
| <b>Lewis and Clark Fund for Exploration and Field Research (not funded)</b><br>\$5,000, American Philosophical Society | <b>2022</b>        |
| <b>Research support award</b><br>\$300, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics                               | <b>2021</b>        |
| <b>Conference funding award</b><br>\$600, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics                             | <b>2020</b>        |
| <b>Conference funding award</b><br>\$762, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics                             | <b>2020</b>        |
| <b>Travel Grant</b><br>\$350, UA Capstone International                                                                | <b>2017</b>        |
| <b>Conference funding award</b><br>\$800, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics                             | <b>2017</b>        |
| <b>Graduate Teaching Assistantship</b><br>UA Modern Languages and Classics                                             | <b>2015 – 2024</b> |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### At Emory University

#### **SPAN 101: Introductory Spanish I**

Visiting Assistant Professor

2024 – present

#### **SPAN 102: Introductory Spanish II**

Visiting Assistant Professor

#### **SPAN 201: Intermediate Spanish I**

Visiting Assistant Professor

#### **SPAN 212: Introduction to Hispanic Texts and Contexts**

Visiting Assistant Professor

### At The University of Alabama

#### **SP 101: Introductory Spanish I**

Graduate Instructor of Record

2015 – 2024

#### **SP 101: Introductory Spanish I (Online)**

Graduate Instructor of Record

#### **SP 102: Introductory Spanish II**

Graduate Instructor of Record

#### **SP 102: Introductory Spanish II (Online)**

Graduate Instructor of Record

#### **SP 103: Intensive Review Spanish**

Graduate Instructor of Record

#### **SP 201: Intermediate Spanish I**

Graduate Instructor of Record

#### **SP 202: Intermediate Spanish II**

Graduate Instructor of Record

#### **SP 353: Spanish Conversation**

Graduate Instructor of Record

#### **SP 356: Advanced Grammar and Composition**

Graduate Instructor of Record

#### **SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language**

Mentored Teaching Assistant to Dr. Bryan Koronkiewicz

## At University of Montevallo

### SPN 101: Introductory Spanish I

Adjunct Instructor

2021 – 2022

### SPN 102: Introductory Spanish II

Adjunct Instructor

### SPN 201: Intermediate Spanish I

Adjunct Instructor

## EDUCATIONAL TECHNOLOGY EXPERIENCE

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- **Online Course Development:** Designed and delivered fully online Spanish courses using video lectures, interactive assessments, and discussion forums to support diverse learning styles and enhance student engagement.
- **Learning Management Systems:** Integrated educational platforms (VHL Central, LingroLearning) into curriculum design, utilizing analytics to monitor student progress and provide personalized feedback for improved learning outcomes.
- **Student Success Support:** Implemented technology-driven assessment and intervention strategies to identify at-risk students early, ensuring equitable access to learning resources and academic support.
- **Faculty Collaboration:** Provided training and technical support to colleagues on effective EdTech integration, fostering collaborative approaches to technology-enhanced language instruction.

## PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

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### Service and Outreach

**Linguistic Society of America Committee on LGBTQ+ [Z] Issues in Linguistics (COZIL)** 2023 – present  
Member

**University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)** 2021 – 2022  
Committee Member

**Graduate Student Representative** 2021 – 2022  
Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA

**LengUA Lab Graduate Student Co-director** 2020 – 2021  
UA (Linguistics research group)

**University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)** 2020 – 2021  
IT Committee member

**Spanish 102 Coordinator** 2020 – 2022  
Spanish Basic Language Program, Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA (43 sections)

**University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)** 2018 – 2019  
Registration Chair

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Vice President, La Última Letra</b><br>UA                                                 | <b>2018 – 2019</b> |
| <b>University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)</b><br>Program Committee member         | <b>2017 – 2018</b> |
| <b>LengUA Lab</b><br>Member                                                                  | <b>2016 – 2024</b> |
| <b>Online Teaching Certification</b><br>UA                                                   | <b>2016 – 2024</b> |
| <b>Secretary, La Última Letra</b><br>UA                                                      | <b>2016 – 2017</b> |
| <b>Vice President/Program Chair, University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)</b><br>UA | <b>2017 – 2018</b> |
| <b>Convención de la Federación de los Círculos de Español de Alabama</b><br>Event Judge      | <b>2015 – 2020</b> |

## Development

**Dissertation Summer Writing Challenge**, The University of Alabama. Summer 2022.

**David Bauer Grant Writing Workshop**, The University of Alabama. Fall 2021.

**Writing for Academic Publication**, Advanced Seminar (CSE 690), The University of Alabama. Spring 2019.

**Spanish Language Immersion Program**, Middlebury Language Schools, Middlebury, VT. Summer 2014.

**Study Abroad in Jaén, Spain**, University of Alabama at Birmingham and Universidad de Jaén. Summer 2011.

## Peer Review

Abstract reviewer, University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)

## Professional Memberships

Member, Linguistics Society of America (LSA)

Member, Acoustical Society of America (ASA)

Member, Alabama World Languages Association (AWLA)

Member, Sigma Delta Pi (Omicron Mu Chapter), National Collegiate Hispanic Honor Society

## Languages

**English** (native)

**Spanish** (near-native proficiency)

**French** (intermediate proficiency)

**Italian** (intermediate proficiency)

## Additional Skills & Interests

**Programming languages:** R, Python, HTML/CSS,  $\text{\LaTeX}$ , Bash/Unix, PRAAT

**Operating systems:** macOS Monterey, Windows 10

**Software:** Microsoft Office 365, Adobe Creative Suite, Qualtrics, RStudio, SPSS, PRAAT, Audacity, Montreal Forced Aligner, ELAN, Zotero, EndNote

**LMS & cloud services:** Blackboard, Canvas, Box, Google Drive, OneDrive, iCloud

## Mentoring

**Jordyn Battistelli**

Fall 2019

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 201 course, UA

**Katie Cauley**

Fall 2020

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

**Jim Moore**

Spring 2021

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

## REFERENCES

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**Dr. Alejandro Herrero-Olaizola**

Chair and Paul & Phyllis Fireman Professor

Department of Spanish and Portuguese

Emory University

alejandros@emory.edu

**Dr. Erin O'Rourke**

Associate Professor of Spanish Linguistics

Department of Modern Languages and Classics

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**Dr. Bryan Koronkiewicz**

Associate Professor of Spanish Linguistics

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